

QA LEADERSHIP ACADEMY

Module 5 Assignment — QA Strategy

Assignment brief: scenario, deliverables, steps and how your work is assessed.

About this assignment

Northstar's squads each have their own definition of done and there is no shared quality gate; executives want speed, engineering wants "more automation", and nobody has defined the problem either solves. Priya has asked you for a QA strategy she can actually stand behind. She does not want a forty-page document — she wants clear choices, honest trade-offs and an explicit statement of what QA will not do.

What you'll demonstrate

- Set a clear direction for quality across the squads
- Make explicit choices and trade-offs, including non-goals
- Tie quality objectives to Northstar's business objectives
- Define quality gates without imposing bureaucracy

What to submit

- A QA Strategy v1 for Northstar (concise, not exhaustive)
- A set of quality objectives linked to business outcomes
- A proposed quality gate model and the trade-offs behind it
- An explicit list of non-goals — what QA will deliberately not own or do yet

Step-by-step

1. Run a quality risk workshop (using the template) to surface where Northstar's real risk sits
2. Set two or three quality objectives that map to shipping faster without more incidents and to a dependable B2B API
3. Use the Quality Gate Decision Matrix to define a gate model squads can adopt without grinding delivery to a halt
4. Write the strategy: current state, direction, the choices you are making and the ones you are consciously deferring
5. State the non-goals plainly so stakeholders know what QA is not promising

Submission format

Submit as a PDF or DOCX — a focused strategy document, deliberately short.

How your work is assessed

If a QA lead reviewed this, they would look for:

- Genuine choices and trade-offs, not a comprehensive list of good practices
- Objectives tied to Northstar's business goals and constraints
- A quality gate model that is enforceable without becoming bureaucracy
- Explicit, credible non-goals
- A document short enough that busy stakeholders will actually read it

Templates & resources to use

- QA Strategy Template — find it in the Resource Vault.
- Quality Risk Workshop Template — find it in the Resource Vault.
- Quality Objectives Worksheet — find it in the Resource Vault.
- Quality Gate Decision Matrix — find it in the Resource Vault.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

A strategy is defined by what you say no to. If your document could describe any company, it is a wish-list — name the trade-offs and the non-goals, and it becomes a strategy.